

Mini Lesson Sample Script

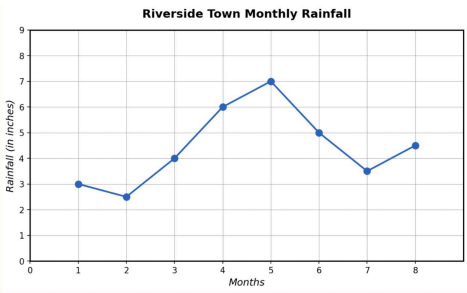
Materials

(S) Activity 1 Worksheet

PROBLEM

1 Read and interpret a line graph.

The line graph below tracks the total rainfall in Riverside Town, measured each month, for 8 months. Use the information in the graph to answer the questions that follow.



- a. How many inches of rain fell in Month 3?
- b. Which month had the greatest amount of rainfall?
- c. There was a large increase in rainfall between Month 4 and Month 5. During what other periods did rainfall increase?
- d. How much more rainfall did the town receive in Month 5 compared to Month 2?

SAMPLE SCRIPT

Give students time to look at the graph.

T: What information does this line graph show us?

S: This line graph shows us the amount of inches it rains each month in Riverside Town.

T: What information is shown on the x-axis, and what are the units?

S: The x-axis shows time in months.

T: And the y-axis?

S: The y-axis shows the amount of rainfall in inches.

T: What do you notice about the rainfall in Riverside Town by looking at the graph?

S: It didn't rain much for the first two months, but then it increased from months 2 to 5 and rained a lot. It decreased again until month 7, and then increased for month 8.

T: How did you know about those increases and decreases?

S: When the line slants up, that's an increase. When it slants down, that means it decreased.

T: Let's start answering the questions. For part (a): how many inches of rain fell in Month 3? How do you know?

S: There were 4 inches of rain in Month 3. I looked at 3 on the x-axis, and the point there has a y-value of 4.

T: Which month had the greatest amount of rainfall? How do you know?

S: Month 5 had the greatest amount. That point is the highest one on the graph. It has the largest y-value.

T: Read (c). When were there other periods of rainfall increasing?

S: The rainfall also increased from Months 2 to 4 and Month 7 to 8. The line segments there are slanting up.

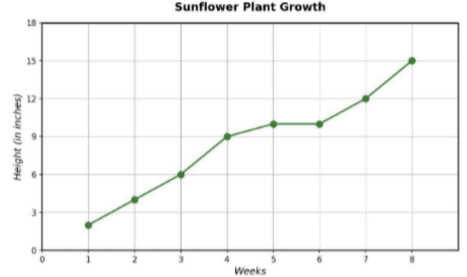
T: How can we solve (d) to find how much more rainfall there was in Month 5 than in Month 2?

S: We can subtract the amount in Month 2 from the amount in Month 5.

PROBLEM

2 Read and interpret a line graph.

The line graph below tracks the height of a sunflower plant, measured each Sunday, for 8 weeks. Use the information in the graph to answer the questions that follow.



- a. About how many inches tall was the plant in Week 2?
- b. Between which two weeks did the plant grow the most?
- c. The plant did not grow at all between weeks 5 and 6. When else did the plant have very little growth? Explain why that might have happened.
- d. What might have caused the rapid growth between weeks 7 and 8?

SAMPLE SCRIPT

T: Now, work independently on problem 2.

S: (Work.)